

Awaken Discovery



Why You Can't Switch Off After Teaching

The 5-Minute Reset That Actually Works

Stop the mental replay.
Calm your body.
Actually switch off after school.

Ally Donoghue

If your day doesn't end when the bell goes...

You're not imagining it.

You leave school...
but your mind doesn't leave with you.

It keeps going.

Replaying moments...

thinking about what you didn't get to...

going over conversations in your head again and again...

Or your body still feels tense.... on edge...

like it hasn't realised the day is over.

And even when you want to relax..... You can't fully switch off...

There's a reason this happens — and it's not your fault.

THE 5-MINUTE RESET

Try this now — before you try to relax.

Your system needs a moment to shift gears.
This reset helps it do that.

This isn't about forcing yourself to switch off.
It's about helping your mind and body come out of "on-duty" mode.

1. *PAUSE (30 seconds)*

Stop. Sit or stand still.

Take one slow breath in... and a longer breath out.

You're not trying to relax.

You're interrupting the momentum of the day.

2. *NAME WHAT'S STILL RUNNING (1 minute)*

Ask yourself: What from today is still "open" in my mind?

Don't analyse it.....Just notice.....

It might be: • a lesson that didn't land • a behaviour moment you're replaying • a conversation you're second-guessing • something unfinished

Naming it helps your brain stop looping it — like closing a tab on your computer that's been running in the background.

3. *RELEASE THE TENSION (1–2 minutes)*

Notice where you feel the day in your body.

Jaw? Shoulders? Chest?

Now gently:

- roll your shoulders
- unclench your jaw
- shake out your hands

You're giving your body permission to let go of what it's been holding.

4. *CLOSE THE DAY (1 minute)*

Say (in your head or out loud): "Today is done."

Not perfect. Not everything is finished. Done.

Your brain rarely gets a clear ending. This gives it one.

5. *SHIFT OUT OF "TEACHER MODE" (1 minute)*

Do one small action that signals the day has changed:

- change your clothes
- step outside
- put music on
- make a drink
- or — if you're exhausted — simply turn your chair to face a different direction.

It doesn't need to be big. It just needs to be intentional.

WHY THIS WORKS

This works because you're not trying to force yourself to relax.

You're helping your system come out of "on mode".

Teaching requires you to stay:

- alert
- responsive
- emotionally engaged
- constantly thinking ahead

Your system adapts to that. So when the day ends... it doesn't automatically switch off.

This reset gives your mind and body a clear signal: **the day is over now.**

You're guiding your nervous system from "on-duty" to "off-duty".

WHAT'S ACTUALLY HAPPENING

This isn't a lack of willpower, and it's not that you're doing anything wrong.

It's that teaching keeps you:

- mentally active
- emotionally responsive
- physically alert

For hours at a time.

Your system gets used to staying "on" so it can keep up with everything around you.

Your mind keeps going... because it's been trained to.

Your body stays alert... because it thinks it still needs to.

Once you understand that...
you can stop fighting it and start working with it.

This is where real change happens

If this helped... this is just the beginning.

The Teacher Realignment System

The Teacher Realignment System shows you how to do this properly — so you're not just coping at the end of the day...
You're actually switching off.

If this reset helped even slightly, imagine what becomes possible when you learn to do this throughout your day — not just at the end of it.

The Teacher Realignment System guides you to release what you're holding, settle your body, quiet the mental replay, and come back to yourself.

You don't have to carry it all.

Explore the full system.

Most teachers wait until burnout forces them to change — you don't have to.

Then:

Explore the full Teacher Realignment System here:

[link]

© Awaken Discovery 2026.

All rights reserved.

This journal is for personal reflection and wellbeing support and is not a substitute for medical, psychological, or therapeutic care.